

gaming than Windows. Most importantly, the Windows OS is heavy on resources. This means that the amount of memory required to just keep Windows running in the background, saps out the processing power available for gaming from a particular hardware configuration. However, even the most resource hungry Linux distro leaves a much smaller memory footprint than XP, let alone Vista. This allows for a game to throw up better graphics and better frame rates.

All Linux distros can be recompiled for use with the specific hardware, making them even more economical, and the games even more faster. Indeed, in many a Lan Party, the Linux user in the crowd has enjoyed faster startup times, and an edge in the crucial first few seconds of the game. What this means is that Linux is actually a very good operating system for gaming. It's just unfortunate that good games are few and far between. Despite this, there is a formidable lineup of mature Linux games.

*Sauerbraten* is a good first person shooter available for Linux, a completely mapable game implemented on the Cube 2 platform. Most popular open source games like *America's Army* are available for Linux. Mods of propriety games that have open source codes like *Wolfenstein: Enemy Territory* and *Urban Terror* are popular in the Linux gaming community, with a fair amount of participation for the online multi-player sessions. The *Quake* engine is very popular

